

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Textual map and source-controlled practice

PATANJALI'S YOGA SUTRA → 4 CHAPTERS

absorption chapter -> mind, practice/dispassion, Lord, absorption

practice chapter -> afflictions, action, eight limbs, discrimination

powers chapter -> integrated concentration, transformations, extraordinary powers

isolation chapter -> realism, cloud-of-virtue absorption, reverse evolution, freedom

Vyāsa supplies the standard five mind-levels; uncertain chronology stays optional

Yoga owns practice/theism; Sāṃkhya owns the shared 25-principle foundation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: Mind-field architecture

YOGA: DISCIPLINE OF THE MIND-FIELD (CITTA)

objects -> senses -> mind-field (citta) -> conscious witness (puruṣa)

determinate intellect (buddhi) + ego-maker (ahaṁkāra) + sensory mind (manas)

intellect -> ego-maker -> sensory mind; only sensory mind arises from sattva-predominant ego-maker

bondage = the witness mistakes reflected mental states for itself

core aim -> restraint of mental modifications (citta-vṛtti-nirodha)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Mental modifications and restraint

FIVE MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTIS)

perception/inference/testimony | error | construction | sleep | memory

each may be afflicted or unafflicted; even valid cognition is a modification

sustained practice (abhyāsa) + dispassion (vairāgya) -> progressive restraint

lower dispassion masters seen/heard objects; higher dispassion relinquishes the qualities

trap: restraint is disciplined lucidity, not unconscious blankness

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Afflictions and karmic chain

ignorance (avidyā) -> ego identification (asmittā)

-> attachment (rāga) / aversion (dveṣa) -> clinging to life (abhiniveśa)

afflictions (kleśas) -> action -> latent deposit -> fruition -> rebirth

preparatory discipline (kriyā-yoga) thins afflictions

meditation burns the remaining seeds and makes discriminative insight possible

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Eight-limbed discipline

EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE (AṢṬĀNGA-YOGA)

ethical restraint -> observance -> posture -> breath regulation

-> sense withdrawal -> concentration -> meditation -> absorption

ethical restraints become the universal great vow beyond place, time, birth or exception

first five prepare body, conduct and attention; final three form integrated concentration

trap: posture is one limb, not the definition or final goal of Yoga

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Absorption ladder

OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (SAMPRAJNATA-SAMADHI)

gross reasoning -> subtle reflection -> joy -> I-am-ness

truth-bearing insight -> objectless absorption -> seedless absorption

condition-based route: videha/prakṛtilaya | means-based route:

faith/energy/memory/absorption/wisdom

cloud-of-virtue absorption (dharmamegha-samādhi) ends affliction and action

nine obstacles disrupt practice; powers are attainments outwardly but obstacles to absorption

do not conflate the four YS 1.17 supports with the separate absorption taxonomy

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Lord and discriminative insight

LORD (ISVARA) = SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS, UNTOUCHED BY AFFLICTION OR ACTION

dedication to the Lord -> concentration aid + timeless teacher

not the material creator of Nyaya and not a substitute for practice

Patañjali: special witness + unsurpassed omniscience + timeless teacher + praṇava

later commentators add theoretical proofs; do not project all of them backward

decisive knowledge = discriminative insight (viveka-khyāti)

Yoga is theistic Samkhya in method, while liberation remains discriminative

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Isolation and the relation problem

ISOLATION (KAIVALYA) – THE WITNESS ESTABLISHED IN ITS OWN NATURE

reverse evolution returns constituent qualities to primordial material nature

objection: how can inactive consciousness relate to insentient mind?

reply: reflection and mere proximity protect the witness from change

residual limit: proximity names the relation more clearly than it explains it

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: PYQ answer synthesis

DEFINE -> CLASSIFY -> EXPLAIN MECHANISM -> CONNECT PRACTICE -> EVALUATE

mind-field -> modifications -> afflictions -> eight limbs -> absorption -> isolation

use the exact question's doctrine; distinguish Lord, witness and mind

add one named objection and the strongest Yoga reply

qualified verdict: rigorous psychology and praxis, contested dualist relation